against a dangerously unprepared country. It looks as ominous in many ways. But in 1973, Israel seized the initiative again after about one week. Now the situation has been moving from bad to worse for more than ten weeks, and no resolution is in sight.

A recent poll among US Democrats indicates that their traditional sympathy for Israel, as opposed to the Palestinians, has been reversed: a majority now sympathizes with the Palestinians. Most Republicans keep supporting Israel. Both results may add to Biden's reticence to invite Netanyahu.

The last two entries can be pushed further. In October 1973, it was Nixon who decided on an airlift of supplies to a badly depleted Israel, since the Soviets had started an airlift to Syria. In case the simmering conflict between Israel and Iran were to turn into full-scale war, with the addition of Iran's proxies and its new ally, Putin's Russia, would Biden come to Israel's assistance, if it were needed? He once promised to do so—but now?

According to news reports, it is inexact to say that Netanyahu accepted Herzog's compromise while Levin opposed it and compelled Netanyahu to backtrack. Netanyahu apparently himself rejected the compromise from the outset. If this is true, Machiavelli would have been proud of our PM: a trickster if there ever was one.

Saturday, March 18

Ramadan starts four days from now: dozens of warnings about attacks. It seems that there is coordination between the various Palestinian organizations; they are aware of Israel's deep internal divisions, that's to say, Israel's weakness.

This afternoon, the eleventh week of demonstrations. Next Thursday, a day of national paralysis. In the meantime, the coalition rushes ahead with the overhaul.